

Knowledge, skills and understanding

This Edexcel GCSE Short Course/Edexcel GCSE in Religious Studies requires students to:

- explore the significance and impact of beliefs, teachings, sources, practices, ways of life and forms of expressing meaning
- express their personal responses and informed insights on fundamental questions and issues about identity, belonging, meaning, purpose, truth, values and commitments
- adopt an enquiring, critical and reflective approach to the study of religion
- explore religions and beliefs, reflect on fundamental questions, and engage with them intellectually and respond personally
- enhance their personal, social and cultural development, their understanding of different cultures locally, nationally and in the wider world, and contribute to social and community cohesion
- develop their interest in and enthusiasm for the study of religion, and relate it to the wider world
- reflect on and develop their own values, opinions and attitudes in light of their learning.

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Unit 1 Religion and Life Based on a Study of Christianity and at Least One Other Religion

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the relationship between religion and life in the UK. There are four sections covering believing in God, matters of life and death, marriage and the family, and religion and community cohesion.

Students are required to base their studies on Christianity and at least ONE, but no more than TWO, of the following religions: Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, Sikhism. However, Section 1 is based on a study of one religion only.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.